

Tilak Tewari ORCID: [0000-0003-2518-4451](https://orcid.org/0000-0003-2518-4451)

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I study environmental history and the history of science, with a focus on colonial South Asia. My current work focuses on scientific practices, particularly glaciology, in High Mountain Asia, c. 1808–1936.

EDUCATION

PhD Environmental History. *Victoria University of Wellington.* Awarded, New Zealand.

2021 – 2025

MA Comparative History. *Central European University.* Distinction, Austria.

2019 – 2020

MA Medieval History. *Jawaharlal Nehru University.* First Division, India.

2016 – 2018

BA (Hons.) History. *University of Delhi.* First Division, India.

2013 – 2016

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Fellow. *Max Planck Institute for the History of Science, Berlin.*

May 2026 – August 2026

An environmental and multispecies history of High Mountain Asia built through colonial survey practices, local power relations, vernacular epistemologies and the formalization of glaciology as an international discipline.

Junior Professional Fellow (Affiliate). *Centre for Ecology Development and Research (Cedar), Dehradun.*

June 2024 – present

Science communication; work with hydrologists and climatologists to translate current environmental research into classroom materials for primary school teachers and students across the Himalaya.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Tewari, Tilak. “‘Only fit for a lunatic asylum’: hybrid expertise and the scientific persona in the Kumaon Himalaya, 1816–36.” *History of Science* (accepted September 2026).

Tewari, Tilak. “Himalayan fossils and the making of global palaeontology: circulation, indigenous expertise, and the production of geological knowledge, c. 1820–1895.” *Geological Curator* 12 (2): 114–129.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Tewari, Tilak, and Arista Roy. *Vanishing Flows: Mussoorie’s Springs and the Price of Progress.* [ArcGIS StoryMaps](https://arcgis.com/storymaps), 2025.

Tewari, Tilak. “Vertical Knowledge: Hill Stations as Localities of Science, Health and Aesthetics in British India, c. 1760–1920.” PhD diss., Te Herenga Waka Victoria University of Wellington, 2025.
<https://doi.org/10.26686/wgtn.28892711>

Tewari, Tilak, and Vidhya Aiyar. “They Chose Death Over Humiliation.” In *Battling for India: A Citizen’s Reader*, edited by Githa Hariharan and Salim Yusufji. New Delhi: Speaking Tiger, 2019.

CONFERENCE PAPERS AND RESEARCH COMMUNICATION

“Towards a ‘cryohistorical’ framework: a multispecies and environmental history of High Mountain Asia.”
Cryohistories and Cryosciences Workshop, Niels Bohr Institute, Copenhagen, July 8–10, 2026.

“Disciplining ice: colonial bodies and the neglected origins of glaciology in high mountain Asia (c. 1808–1860).” Manchester Workshop Series on Natural Archives and the History of Science in Asia, November 17, 2025.

“Specimens of empire: extraction, control, and the global inequities of science.” GCG EDI Symposium, Geological Curators’ Group, April 9, 2025.

“From highlands to hill stations: Scots in the mountains of India.” Scottish Graduate School for Arts & Humanities. <https://sgsahresearch.com/portfolio/tilak-tewari/>

“Indigenous specialists: Shaping 19th century scientific practices in the Himalaya.” Earth Sciences FRESH Symposium, University of St Andrews, Scotland, May 24, 2024.

“The climate of nineteenth century medicine: miasma, meteorology, and mountains” (prerecorded). Earth Scholars Global Connect, 2024.

“Imperial heights: hill stations in the British Empire (1820–1920).” European Society of Environmental History Conference, University of Bern, Switzerland, August 22–27, 2023.

FELLOWSHIPS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND AWARDS

2024 British Council, SGSAH EARTH Scholarship	£10,000
2023 Te Herenga Waka Large Faculty Grant	NZ\$6,000
2021 Wellington Doctoral Scholarship	NZ\$30,500 p.a.
2019 CEU Tuition Scholarship	€12,000
2018 University Grants Commission, NET Award	Qualified for Assistant Professor eligibility nationally

TEACHING

Tutor and Course Coordinator. *Victoria University of Wellington.*

Feb 2023 – May 2024

Facilitated seminars and graded written work for HIST315 (American History) and CSIS315 (History of Science & Technology); independently designed and delivered a full instructional module “South Asia and Global Environmental History” for CSIS315.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Research Associate, Intangible Cultural Heritage Division. *INTACH, New Delhi.*

Dec 2018 – May 2019

Led creation of a digital heritage archive; managed multiple publications, including conference proceedings and a government-commissioned coffee-table book.

Editor. *Indian Cultural Forum, New Delhi.*

Dec 2016 – June 2017

Our collective [publishes](#) outstanding works by Indian cultural practitioners online, providing a space free from intimidation, censorship, and exclusion, with open access for all readers.

LANGUAGES

Fluent: English, Hindi

Reading proficiency (archival research): Ottoman Turkish, Persian

Beginner: German (CEFR A1), Korean (reading, writing)